Independence, which has never been treated as the central narrative of Partition by mainstream historians, has now ricocheted with a vengeance and returned to haunt the subcontinent, which appears to have learnt nothing from the forced migration of 15 million on account of their religion. Citizenship and the right to be in a homeland, the very essence of belongingness, are being bestowed on one group of migrants but denied to others of a different faith. It was not for this that Bhagat Singh mounted the scaffold, so willingly, with such conviction, and in such great hope for the future. What India most urgently needs in the circumstances of today is not so much an apology from Britain but a '*Vergangenheitsbewältigung*' of its own where it can strive to overcome its own negatives and work through not only its own past but also its own present – its here and now. It needs, in the words of Edward Thompson, its own *prayaschitta.* Its *atonement* for its own deeds.